EL72

Team Business Strategy, Product Roadmap & Financial Model

A study document for the EL72 CS/AI team

CURRENT STATE: PRE-LAUNCH • 0 USERS • MVP IN DEVELOPMENT • PRIMARY MONETIZATION HYPOTHESIS: AFFILIATE COMMISSIONS

Planning horizon: 12 months, with 12–36 month future directions.

Market focus: Egypt first, followed by potential GCC/MENA expansion.

Purpose: align the technical and business team on what EL72 is trying to prove, what should be built, what should be measured, and when decisions should be made.

The five labels used throughout

Label	Meaning
FACT	Supported by a source or an observed/current EL72 state.
ASSUMPTION	A condition EL72 currently believes may be true but has not validated.
ESTIMATE	A model-derived numerical approximation used for planning.
INFERENCE	A conclusion derived from multiple facts or observations.
RECOMMENDATION	A strategic decision proposed for EL72.

> **Important: A model number is not a market fact. The financial tables in this report are planning models designed to show what must become true.**

Executive takeaway

The recommended starting model is free shopping intelligence with a free tracker and affiliate commissions as the primary initial revenue source. The tracker is treated as a retention and purchase-intent engine rather than as a product that must directly charge users.

The key risk is that affiliate revenue per user may be too small unless EL72 generates high-intent shopping behavior at meaningful scale. Therefore, the first year should optimize for validation and learning before aggressive revenue maximization.

1. Current State of EL72

EL72 is currently a product in development. The team is building both a mobile application and a web application. There are zero current users, so no acquisition, retention, affiliate, or willingness-to-pay metric has been validated yet.

Current product direction

Capability	What it does	Why it matters
Product discovery	Lets users search for products.	Creates shopping intent.
Price comparison	Compares available merchant offers.	Reduces search effort and can generate merchant clicks.
Price history	Shows how a product's price has behaved over time.	Provides context beyond the current price.
Fake-discount detection	Evaluates whether a discount is meaningful relative to historical/reference prices.	Builds trust and differentiates EL72.
Price tracking	Monitors a product until a target price is reached.	Creates a reason for users to return.
Alerts	Notifies users when meaningful price events happen.	Converts stored intent into a return session.
Affiliate links	Sends users to merchants through trackable links.	Creates the initial revenue opportunity.

The central economic loop

DISCOVER → COMPARE → VERIFY → TRACK → WAIT → ALERT → RETURN → BUY → AFFILIATE COMMISSION

The most important thing for the technical team to understand is that the tracker is not an isolated feature. It exists inside a behavioral loop. If tracking increases return visits and purchases, it can be economically valuable even if the tracker itself is free.

2. The Strategic Change: Paid Tracker → Free Tracker

The previous business model considered three free tracking credits followed by paid tracking credits. The new hypothesis removes direct payment for basic tracking and makes affiliate commissions the primary revenue source.

Dimension	Old Model	New Hypothesis
Tracker	Paid credits after free allowance	Free with reasonable fair-use limits
Primary revenue	Tracking credits + affiliate	Affiliate commissions
User friction	Payment required for continued tracking	No payment barrier for core tracking
Main purpose of tracker	Product + direct monetization	Retention + purchase intent
Main KPI	Paid tracking / revenue	Qualified shopping actions + affiliate economics
Main risk	Payment friction suppresses adoption	Free usage may not monetize enough
Scale requirement	Potentially lower	Potentially higher

Why the free model is attractive at zero users

- It removes a payment decision before the user trusts the product.
- It encourages more tracking, creating more opportunities for return visits.

- It produces more behavioral data about product interest and target prices.
- It increases the number of users who can eventually click merchant links.
- It makes the product easier to market: 'track for free' is a simple value proposition.

Why free tracking can fail

- Users may track products without ever buying.
- Large numbers of inactive trackers can create infrastructure and notification costs.
- WhatsApp alerts can become expensive if used indiscriminately.
- Affiliate revenue may be too low per active user.
- The product may attract low-intent users simply because it is free.

> **RECOMMENDATION: Keep basic tracking free, but use fair-use limits and rate limiting to prevent abuse. Do not turn limits into artificial payment friction during the validation year.**

3. What EL72 Is Actually Selling

EL72 is not fundamentally selling price data. Price data is an input.

The user-facing value is a better purchase decision.

Weak positioning	Stronger positioning
We compare prices.	We help you find the real best price.
We track products.	We tell you when a tracked product reaches a price worth considering.
We detect discounts.	We tell you whether a discount is actually meaningful.
We have AI.	We use data and AI where it improves shopping decisions.

> **Recommended positioning: “Don't just find the price. Know if it's a good deal.”**

This positioning gives the technical team a clearer objective: model accuracy is valuable only when it improves the user's decision.

4. Product Architecture Through a Business Lens

The team is primarily composed of CS/AI students, so it is useful to map the business model directly to technical systems.

Business requirement	Technical system	Key engineering metric
Accurate comparison	Product normalization + merchant data pipeline	Product-match accuracy
Reliable prices	Scraping/API ingestion + validation	Price accuracy / freshness
Real discounts	Historical price store + scoring logic	Deal-score accuracy
Useful tracking	Scheduler + state management	Alert accuracy / latency
Personalized alerts	Event detection + notification service	Alert open/return rate
Affiliate monetization	Redirect + attribution instrumentation	Affiliate CTR / EPC
Learning loop	Analytics/event pipeline	Retention / revenue per MAU

Important engineering principle

> **Every major feature should have a measurable business hypothesis attached to it.**

For example, building a more sophisticated price-drop model is not automatically valuable. The team should be able to state: 'We expect this model to improve alert relevance, which should increase return rate and ultimately affiliate revenue.'

5. Market and Competitive Reality

EL72 is entering an existing category. Egypt already has price-comparison and shopping-intelligence products. This means 'we compare prices' is not sufficient differentiation.

Relevant precedents

Company / Product	Relevant lesson for EL72
Pricena	Regional price comparison and historical-price tracking show that comparison alone is not new.
KanBkam	Price history and price-drop notifications already exist in MENA.
EGPrices	Egypt has had price-comparison services for many years.
Yaoota	Egyptian price comparison can attract users and investment, but scale and business economics matter.
Bkam	A useful comparison product can still fail if financing and business economics are not sustainable.
ShopSavvy	Free comparison + price tracking + affiliate monetization is a direct international precedent.
Honey	Shopping assistance becomes valuable when it influences purchase decisions, not just when it finds coupons.
Rakuten	Free consumer access can be funded by merchant commissions.
Klarna	Shopping intelligence can evolve into advertising, affiliate, payments and broader commerce infrastructure.

Competitive threats

- Google Shopping/search can increasingly answer product-comparison questions.
- Amazon, Jumia and Noon already own large portions of the shopping journey.
- AI assistants can increasingly perform shopping research.
- Existing comparison sites can copy individual features.
- Affiliate networks and merchants control important parts of the monetization layer.

What EL72 must own

> **The defensible goal is not 'cheapest price.' It is trusted, localized shopping intelligence: product identity + price history + deal quality + merchant comparison + personalized timing.**

6. Egypt Opportunity

Egypt is the initial market because it combines a large digital audience with a growing e-commerce market and fragmented merchants.

Research highlights

- DataReportal reported approximately 98.2 million internet users in Egypt at the end of 2025, representing 82.7% penetration.

- DataReportal reported approximately 51.6 million social-media user identities and 48.8 million adult TikTok advertising-reach users.
- Euromonitor reported retail e-commerce value in Egypt reached approximately EGP 166.9 billion in 2025, with 30% value growth.
- Amazon Egypt and Noon are major marketplace participants, but the market remains fragmented.

These are external research findings used in the strategic analysis. They are not EL72 internal metrics.

Why fragmentation helps EL72

If a shopper is deciding between multiple merchants, an independent comparison layer can reduce the effort required to check each store manually. EL72's opportunity increases when the same product is available from multiple merchants at meaningfully different prices.

Why Egypt is different from the US

- Price sensitivity and currency/inflation effects make price timing important.
- Merchant fragmentation creates comparison opportunities.
- WhatsApp is an important communication channel, but its business messaging economics must be treated carefully.
- Trust and merchant quality matter alongside price.
- The product should be localized rather than simply copying a US shopping model.

7. Affiliate Economics — The Core Revenue Engine

Affiliate economics should be understood as a funnel rather than a single commission percentage.

Affiliate Revenue = Affiliate Clicks × Merchant Conversion × AOV × Commission Rate

A more useful per-user expression is:

Affiliate Revenue / User = Searches/User × High-Intent Rate × Affiliate CTR × Merchant Conversion × AOV × Commission Rate

Why category selection matters

Affiliate rates can differ dramatically by category. Amazon Egypt's official rate card, for example, lists mobile phones at a much lower commission than categories such as apparel, watches or books. Therefore a category with huge search volume may not be the most economically attractive.

Variables the team must eventually measure

Variable	Meaning	Why it matters
Affiliate CTR	Share of eligible users who click a merchant link.	Measures purchase intent and outbound conversion.
Merchant conversion	Share of affiliate clicks that become purchases.	Determines whether traffic monetizes.
AOV	Average order value.	Higher AOV increases revenue at a fixed commission.
Commission rate	Merchant/network payout percentage.	Determines revenue per GMV.
EPC	Earnings per click.	Useful compact measure of affiliate quality.
Return/reversal rate	Purchases that later reverse or are not commissionable.	Protects against overstating revenue.
Attribution window	Time during which a click can receive credit.	Changes expected conversion economics.

What to build technically

- Merchant-level affiliate configuration.
- Category-level commission configuration.
- Redirect/attribution event logging.
- Click-to-purchase reporting where networks expose it.
- Dashboard for EPC, CTR, conversion and revenue by merchant/category.

Do not hard-code one global commission assumption into the product strategy. The business model should be data-driven by merchant and category.

8. WhatsApp and Notification Economics

WhatsApp is attractive because it can bring users back at exactly the moment a price changes. It is also a potential variable-cost risk.

Meta's WhatsApp Business Platform uses message-based pricing that varies by category and market. Therefore EL72 should not assume every price alert has the same cost.

Recommended notification hierarchy

Channel	Role
Push notification	Default, low-cost product alert channel.
Email	Secondary notification and recovery channel.
WhatsApp	High-engagement optional channel for users who explicitly opt in.

Engineering implication

- Create notification preferences per user and per product.
- Batch low-value events instead of sending repeated messages.
- Only alert when the price movement is meaningful.
- Track notification cost and downstream affiliate revenue.
- Measure incremental value of WhatsApp users against their incremental messaging cost.

The correct question is not 'Can we send WhatsApp alerts?' It is 'Does WhatsApp create more contribution than it costs?'

9. Recommended Initial Categories

Category	Why it is attractive	Main concern	Priority
Laptops	High AOV, research-heavy, strong comparison and timing use case.	Competition and lower-frequency purchases.	1
Gaming	High-intent communities, meaningful prices, deal-sensitive users.	Smaller total market than general electronics.	2
Consumer electronics	Many merchants and meaningful price differences.	Product matching complexity.	3

Smartphones	Huge demand and strong comparison behavior.	Some affiliate programs have low commission rates.	4
Home appliances	High AOV and strong price-comparison rationale.	Larger product catalog and merchant complexity.	5

Start narrow. A smaller, accurate catalog is more valuable than a large catalog with incorrect product matches and stale prices.

10. Customer Acquisition Strategy

Channel 1 — Product-specific SEO

The strongest long-term channel hypothesis is search traffic around specific purchase decisions, for example: '[product] price Egypt', 'best laptop under X EGP', '[product] price history', and 'is this discount real?'

Channel 2 — Short-form deal content

TikTok, Instagram Reels and YouTube Shorts can turn the fake-discount detector and price-history features into content.

- “Amazon says 35% off. Is it actually?”
- “This laptop is cheaper today — but should you buy it?”
- “Three fake discounts we found this week.”

Channel 3 — Communities and referrals

University communities, gaming communities, technology groups, Telegram, WhatsApp and relevant Reddit communities can be used for early validation.

Do not scale paid acquisition yet

Until EL72 knows activation, retention, affiliate CTR and revenue per acquired user, paid acquisition can simply buy users whose economic value is unknown.

11. North Star Metric and KPI System

Recommended North Star Metric: Monthly Qualified Shopping Actions (QSA)

A QSA is a meaningful shopping-intent event such as a product comparison, product tracking action, or merchant click. The exact definition should be finalized once analytics data exists.

Stage	Metrics
Acquisition	Visitors, signup conversion, CAC, organic traffic, referral rate
Activation	First search, first comparison, first tracked product, first alert
Engagement	Searches/user, tracked products/user, sessions/user
Retention	D7, D30, D90, returning users
Affiliate	Affiliate CTR, EPC, merchant conversion, AOV, revenue/user, GMV/user
Product quality	Search success, price accuracy, product-match accuracy, alert accuracy, merchant coverage

The most important eventual number

Affiliate contribution generated by one retained shopper over their lifetime.

This number eventually determines whether the free-tracker model can support paid acquisition and organizational scale.

12. Financial Model — How the Team Should Read It

The following model is intentionally an estimate. It is not a forecast and should not be presented as if the assumptions are already validated.

Base planning assumptions

Variable	Illustrative base assumption
MAU / registered-user relationship	50–80% depending on stage
Searches / MAU	Approximately 1.8–3.0
High-intent searches	Approximately 50%
Affiliate CTR	22%
Merchant conversion	5.5%
AOV	EGP 4,500
Blended commission	4.5%
Tracker adoption	Approximately 35%
Planning exchange-rate assumption	EGP 52/USD

Illustrative scale economics

Registered users	MAU	Affiliate revenue / month (illustrative)
100	75	EGP 276
500	375	EGP 1.38K
1,000	750	EGP 2.76K
5,000	3,750	EGP 13.8K
10,000	7,500	EGP 27.6K
50,000	37,500	EGP 137.8K
100,000	75,000	EGP 275.7K

Key lesson: 10,000 registered users does not automatically mean a large business. EL72 needs strong intent, retention and affiliate economics—not vanity user numbers.

13. Break-Even Logic

A simple contribution-margin model can be written as:

Contribution per MAU = Affiliate revenue per MAU − Variable cost per MAU

Then:

Break-even MAU = Fixed monthly operating cost ÷ Contribution per MAU

Under one illustrative base case, contribution could be around EGP 2–3 per MAU/month. That means a business carrying EGP 60,000/month in fixed costs could require tens of thousands of MAU to break even.

The exact threshold is not known until real affiliate, notification and infrastructure data are collected.

What this means for the team

- Do not hire ahead of validated economics.
- Do not assume affiliate revenue appears immediately after launch.
- Keep the infrastructure lean.
- Measure contribution margin continuously.
- Treat the first year as an experiment with financial constraints.

14. 0–3 Month Plan: Build → Beta → Validate

Area	Objectives	Deliverables	Evidence required
Product	Finish a coherent MVP	Search, comparison, history, deal score, tracking, alerts	Users can complete the core journey
Data	Improve price/product reliability	Normalization, ingestion, validation	Acceptable match and price accuracy
Affiliate	Establish monetization plumbing	Affiliate accounts + redirect tracking	Clicks are attributable
Analytics	Make behavior measurable	Event schema + dashboard	Every key funnel step is observable
Growth	Find first users	Closed beta	50–200 real users
Research	Test value proposition	User interviews + experiments	Clear patterns in why users return or leave

Go / no-go questions at Month 3

1. Can users successfully find products?
2. Do they trust the comparison and deal information?
3. Do they track products?
4. Do alerts bring users back?
5. Do users click merchants?
6. Which category has the strongest behavior?

15. 3–6 Month Plan: Product-Market Signals

The team should now stop asking only whether people can use EL72 and start asking whether EL72 creates repeated behavior.

Focus metrics

- D30 retention
- Searches per user
- Tracker adoption
- Return after price alert
- Affiliate CTR
- Category-level performance
- Organic acquisition

Expected strategic decision

At this stage, EL72 may discover that one category or one acquisition channel is dramatically stronger than the others. If that happens, concentrate resources rather than expanding scope.

16. 6–9 Month Plan: Traction

Only after positive product-market signals should EL72 increase acquisition investment.

Scale candidates

- Product-specific SEO
- Short-form content
- Referral loops
- Tech and gaming communities
- Creator partnerships
- Merchant partnerships

Optimization questions

- Which merchant produces the highest EPC?
- Which category produces the highest contribution/user?
- Which acquisition source produces the best retained users?
- Which alert channel creates the highest incremental purchase activity?
- Which products are most frequently tracked?

17. 9–12 Month Plan: Scale or Pivot

By this stage EL72 should have enough evidence to choose a direction.

Scenario	Signal	Response
A — Strong PMF	Strong retention + strong affiliate economics	Scale acquisition and product.
B — Strong users, weak monetization	People return but revenue/user is low	Improve merchant/category economics and add monetization carefully.
C — Strong affiliate revenue, weak retention	Users click/buy but do not return	Improve tracker and shopping intelligence.
D — Strong tracking, weak affiliate conversion	Users track but do not buy through EL72	Improve purchase flow, merchant ranking and deal confidence.
E — Strong niche	One category dominates	Own the niche before expanding.
F — Weak overall traction	Low activation and retention	Pivot or narrow the problem.

18. Product Roadmap vs Business Roadmap

Build	Validate	Monetize	Do not build yet
Search	Search demand	Affiliate links	General AI shopping agent
Comparison	Comparison usage	Merchant optimization	Cashback
Price history	Trust in history	Sponsored placements later	B2B platform
Deal scoring	Deal-score usefulness	Affiliate revenue	MENA-wide expansion
Tracking	Tracker adoption	Potential premium later	Social shopping network
Alerts	Return-after-alert	Merchant partnerships	Complex loyalty system
Analytics	Retention	Future data products	Large-scale paid acquisition

This separation is designed to prevent feature creep. A feature can be technically interesting without being the next correct business investment.

19. Future Directions

The following are possible future products, not commitments.

Direction	Why it could matter	When to consider it
Price prediction	Turns historical data into a decision advantage.	After enough clean price-history data exists.
Buy vs Wait	Transforms comparison into a direct recommendation.	After deal scoring is trusted.
Personalized deal alerts	Improves relevance and retention.	After user behavior is measurable.
AI shopping assistant	Could combine search, comparison and personalization.	After EL72 has strong structured shopping data.
Browser extension	Captures shopping intent at checkout/research time.	After core economics work.
Merchant trust scoring	Adds quality to cheapest-price ranking.	After merchant data is sufficient.
B2B price intelligence	Could monetize EL72's data directly.	After the data asset is demonstrably valuable.
MENA expansion	Expands TAM.	After Egypt playbook is repeatable.

20. Data Moat — What Could Become Defensible?

A static database is not a moat. The potential defensibility comes from the combination of time-series data and behavior.

Data asset	Potential value
Product normalization	Connects the same product across merchants.
Merchant pricing	Creates cross-store price intelligence.
Price history	Supports historical context and prediction.
Discount history	Helps identify misleading reference prices.
Price volatility	Helps estimate when waiting is worthwhile.
Search behavior	Shows what consumers intend to buy.
Tracking behavior	Shows what consumers are willing to wait for.
Target prices	Captures explicit purchase intent.
Alert response	Shows whether a price event triggers action.
Merchant reliability	Can eventually improve merchant ranking.

The potential moat is: PRODUCT × MERCHANT × PRICE × TIME × USER INTENT.

21. Investor Red Team

Question	Honest current answer
Why will users care?	Potentially because EL72 reduces uncertainty around whether to buy now and whether a discount is real.
Why won't Google solve this?	It may. EL72 needs better localized historical price intelligence and trust.
Why won't Amazon solve this?	An independent comparison layer can be merchant-neutral.

Why won't AI assistants solve this?	They may. EL72 needs structured, continuously updated shopping data.
Why will affiliate economics work?	Unknown today; it must be validated through clicks, conversion, AOV and commissions.
What is the moat?	Not yet proven. The potential is accumulated price and shopping-intent data.
Why Egypt?	Large digital audience, growing e-commerce and fragmented merchants.
Can it become large?	Potentially, but affiliate-only economics require meaningful scale or later monetization expansion.
What kills it?	Low retention, inaccurate data, weak affiliate economics, high acquisition cost, or platform commoditization.

22. What the CS/AI Team Should Understand

1. The model is a feedback system

Users create searches. Searches create product-intent signals. Tracking creates future events. Price changes create notifications. Notifications create return sessions. Return sessions create merchant clicks. Clicks can create purchases. Purchases create affiliate revenue. That revenue funds the system.

2. Data quality is a business feature

If product matching is wrong, the comparison is wrong. If price history is wrong, the deal score is wrong. If the deal score is wrong, trust falls. Therefore data engineering and ML quality directly affect revenue.

3. Accuracy has economic value

A better matching model is valuable when it increases successful comparisons, user trust, retention or affiliate conversion. The team should connect model metrics to product metrics.

4. Don't optimize offline metrics in isolation

A model can have better F1 or accuracy while producing no improvement in user behavior. EL72 should eventually run controlled experiments where possible.

5. Instrument before optimizing

If the system does not log the user funnel, the team cannot know which part of the business is broken.

23. Recommended Analytics Event Model

A simple event taxonomy will make later business analysis much easier.

Event	Example fields
search	user_id, query, timestamp, category
product_view	user_id, product_id, source
comparison_view	product_id, merchants_shown, best_price
track_created	product_id, target_price, notification_channel
price_change	product_id, old_price, new_price
alert_sent	product_id, channel, event_type
alert_opened	user_id, product_id, channel
merchant_click	merchant_id, product_id, affiliate_id
purchase	merchant_id, value, commission, status if available
track_removed	product_id, reason if available

The exact schema can evolve, but the team should design analytics before launch rather than attempting to reconstruct behavior later.

24. Technical Priorities for the First Year

Priority	Why
Product normalization	Without it, cross-merchant comparisons are unreliable.
Price data quality	The entire value proposition depends on trustworthy prices.
Historical storage	Required for deal scoring and future prediction.
Tracking scheduler	Core retention mechanism.
Notification reliability	A missed alert destroys trust.
Affiliate attribution	Required to prove monetization.
Analytics pipeline	Required to validate every business hypothesis.
Search quality	Activation depends on finding the intended product.
Anti-abuse/rate limiting	Protects free tracker economics.

Technologies that should not become goals by themselves

- Using an LLM because it is fashionable.
- Building a sophisticated agent before the core comparison loop works.
- Adding microservices before the system needs them.
- Training complex models when a deterministic system is sufficient.
- Scaling infrastructure before there is traffic.

Use AI where it produces measurable improvement. Do not confuse technical novelty with product value.

25. Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Impact	Early warning	Mitigation
Low retention	Very high	Users do not return after first search	Improve tracker, alerts and decision value.
Bad product matching	Very high	User complaints / low comparison trust	Improve normalization and evaluation set.
Stale prices	Very high	Incorrect merchant prices	Freshness monitoring and validation.
Weak affiliate conversion	High	Clicks without purchases	Improve merchant ranking/category selection.
WhatsApp cost	Medium/High	Messaging cost grows faster than revenue	Push-first strategy and meaningful-event alerts.
SEO dependency	High	Most traffic from one channel	Diversify acquisition.
Competitor copying	High	Feature parity	Build data and trust advantages.
Feature creep	High	Roadmap keeps expanding	Use build/validate/do-not-build framework.
Premature hiring	High	Fixed cost grows before revenue	Hire against validated bottlenecks.

26. Team Decision Gates

Gate	Question	Decision
Gate 1	Do users activate?	Fix onboarding/product if no.
Gate 2	Do users return?	Improve tracker/alerts if no.
Gate 3	Do users click merchants?	Improve purchase flow if no.
Gate 4	Do clicks convert?	Improve merchant/category economics if no.
Gate 5	Does contribution exceed variable cost?	Optimize economics before scaling.
Gate 6	Can acquisition scale profitably?	Scale, specialize, or pivot.

Every major roadmap review should explicitly state which gate EL72 is currently trying to pass.

27. Final Strategic Recommendation

Recommended business model: FREE SHOPPING INTELLIGENCE + FREE TRACKING + AFFILIATE MONETIZATION

The free tracker is strategically appropriate for a pre-launch product with zero users because it removes friction and potentially increases retention, purchase intent and affiliate opportunities.

However, the free tracker should not be treated as proven. The team must test whether additional tracking actually creates additional merchant clicks and purchases.

The company should begin with a narrow, high-intent category focus and build strong product matching, price history, deal scoring, tracking, notifications and analytics.

The business should remain lean until real data proves that acquisition, retention and affiliate economics can scale.

The sequence

BUILD → LAUNCH → LEARN → VALIDATE → RETAIN → MONETIZE → SCALE

The strategic destination

The long-term opportunity is not merely an affiliate comparison website. If EL72 accumulates high-quality product, merchant, price-history and shopping-intent data, it can evolve into a shopping-intelligence platform capable of personalized deal alerts, buy-vs-wait recommendations, price prediction, AI shopping assistance, merchant intelligence and eventually B2B/data products.

28. Team Study Checklist

Every team member should be able to answer these questions after studying the report.

7. What problem does EL72 solve that Amazon or Google does not completely solve?
8. Why is the tracker free in the new model?
9. How does a free tracker eventually generate affiliate revenue?
10. What is the difference between affiliate CTR, merchant conversion, AOV, commission and EPC?
11. Why can 10,000 users still be economically insufficient?

12. Why is product matching a business-critical ML/data problem?
13. Why should push notifications be the default before WhatsApp?
14. What makes price history valuable?
15. Why is a product database alone not a data moat?
16. What are the first three acquisition channels to test?
17. What are the six validation gates?
18. What should the team NOT build during the first validation period?
19. When should paid acquisition begin?
20. What evidence would justify expanding from Egypt to GCC?
21. What evidence would justify keeping the tracker completely free?
22. What evidence would justify adding premium features?

29. Glossary for the CS/AI Team

Term	Plain-English meaning
AOV	Average Order Value — average value of a completed purchase.
Affiliate CTR	Percentage of eligible users who click an affiliate merchant link.
Affiliate conversion	Percentage of affiliate clicks that become purchases.
EPC	Earnings Per Click — affiliate earnings divided by clicks.
GMV	Gross Merchandise Value — total value of transactions influenced by the platform.
MAU	Monthly Active Users.
CAC	Customer Acquisition Cost — average cost to acquire a customer/user.
LTV	Lifetime Value — expected economic contribution of a user over their lifetime.
Contribution margin	Revenue remaining after variable costs.
Attribution window	Period in which a merchant can credit a purchase to an affiliate click.
Product normalization	Mapping different merchant listings to the same underlying product.
Product matching	Determining whether two listings represent the same product.
Price history	Historical record of a product's observed prices.
Deal score	A metric estimating how attractive the current price is relative to relevant historical/reference prices.
Retention	Whether users return and continue using the product over time.
PMF	Product-market fit — evidence that a product strongly satisfies a market need.
North Star Metric	The main metric representing the product's core value creation.
Fair-use limit	A usage limit designed to prevent abuse without necessarily charging the user.
E-commerce affiliate	A model where a merchant pays for traffic or sales generated through a partner.

30. Selected Research Sources

The report combines the supplied EL72 strategy brief with external market and company research. External sources should be rechecked before the team uses numerical values in an investor document.

- **Amazon Egypt Associates — official commission/help documentation:** https://affiliate-program.amazon.eg/
- **Meta WhatsApp Business Platform — official pricing:** https://business.whatsapp.com/products/platform-pricing
- **DataReportal — Digital 2026: Egypt:** https://datareportal.com/reports/digital-2026-egypt
- **Euromonitor / Retail E-Commerce in Egypt:** https://lp.euromonitor.com/retail-e-commerce-in-egypt/report
- **ShopSavvy — company information:** https://shopsavvy.com/about
- **ShopSavvy — affiliate disclosure:** https://shopsavvy.com/disclosure
- **PayPal — Honey acquisition announcement:** https://newsroom.uk.paypal-corp.com/2019-11-20-PayPal-to-Acquire-Honey
- **Capital One — Wikibuy:** https://www.capitalone.com/tech/software-engineering/saving-money-online-is-easy-and-fast-with-wikibuy-from-capital-one/
- **Egypt Personal Data Protection Center:** https://www.pdpc.gov.eg/
- **ArabClicks — advertiser/program explorer:** https://www.arabclicks.com/advertisers/advertisers-explorer/

Source note

The original EL72 brief explicitly requires important numerical claims to be sourced and requires assumptions to be distinguished from facts. The financial figures in this report are therefore labeled as illustrative estimates where they have not been validated by EL72's own operating data.

Appendix A — One-Page Team Summary

EL72 in one sentence: A free shopping-intelligence platform that helps Egyptian consumers decide whether a product is actually a good deal and monetizes high-intent purchases through affiliate commissions.

Question	Answer
Who is the user?	Price-sensitive online shoppers researching meaningful purchases.
Core problem?	Consumers do not know whether a current price is genuinely good or whether they should wait.
Core features?	Search, comparison, price history, deal detection, tracking, alerts.
Why free tracking?	Increase adoption, retention, purchase intent and affiliate opportunities.
How does EL72 make money?	Primarily affiliate commissions initially.
First categories?	Laptops, gaming, electronics, smartphones, selected appliances.
First acquisition?	Product SEO, short-form deal content, communities/referrals.
First technical priorities?	Product matching, price accuracy, history, tracking, alerts, attribution, analytics.
What proves success?	Repeat use + merchant clicks + purchases + positive contribution margin.
What should we avoid?	Premature scaling, feature creep, expensive infrastructure, broad category expansion.
Long-term opportunity?	Shopping intelligence → personalized buy/wait decisions → AI assistant → data/B2B products.